

MATTHEW VELLA

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity undergraduate at FIU Honors College (Minor: Artificial Intelligence), Platinum-tier CyberPatriot Linux Team Lead, with five production applications shipped end-to-end — including two live on the Apple App Store. Approaches software with security built in from the first design decision, not bolted on afterward. Seeking a Summer 2027 Security Engineering internship.

EDUCATION

Florida International University — Honors College *In Progress*

B.S. Cybersecurity, Minor in Artificial Intelligence | GPA: 3.76 | Relevant Coursework: Discrete Mathematics (Graph Theory, Combinatorics, Predicate Logic), Java Programming

McFatter Technical College *Graduated*

CTE Degree in Applied Cybersecurity

SECURITY & CYBER DEFENSE

- CyberPatriot National Youth Cyber Defense Competition — Platinum Tier, Linux Team Lead: hardened Ubuntu, Kali, and Mint systems against live-fire red-team scoring.
- Studying for CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) — Target Exam: December 2026
- Hands-on practice via TryHackMe, applying network security, Linux administration, and threat-detection fundamentals
- Silver Knight Award Nominee — Vocational-Technical Category, Miami Herald

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security & Systems: Linux hardening (Ubuntu, Kali, Mint), Wireshark, Cisco Packet Tracer, OAuth / token-based auth, Row-Level Security (RLS) policy design, Tailscale

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, Swift, Rust

Frameworks & Runtime: Next.js, React Native / Expo, Node.js, Tauri 2.0

Backend & Infrastructure: Supabase (Postgres, RLS), Vercel, Stripe API, Resend, REST APIs, Webhooks

Tools: Xcode, App Store Connect, Git/GitHub, Cursor, CI/CD

PROJECTS

CyberSimply — Founder & Solo Developer 2025 – Present

- Architected a security-conscious content pipeline for cybersecurity news — RSS ingestion → LLM classification → Supabase-backed deduplication → rate-limited push delivery — live on the Apple App Store.
- Enforced per-user data isolation with Supabase Row-Level Security (RLS) policies and rate-limited delivery to prevent notification abuse; hardened the pipeline against silent failures with automated health checks and alerting.
- Built with React Native, Expo, TypeScript, and Supabase.

AlarmQR — Founder & Solo Developer 2025 – Present

- Designed a tamper-resistant, anti-spoof dismissal control: a physical QR scan gated by a unique per-install token, preventing accidental or fraudulent alarm dismissal — built on a native Swift bridge (VisionKit) and AlarmKit.
- Shipped a re-engagement notification system (streak-risk, milestone, and win-back alerts); App Store analytics show 204% download growth and 15.8% install-to-scan conversion following launch.
- Built with React Native, Expo, Swift, and Supabase.

VoiceLocal — Founder & Solo Developer 2026

- Built a privacy-first macOS dictation app with zero cloud processing of audio or text — all transcription and injection handled on-device via a Tauri 2.0 + Rust backend and a native Swift sidecar.
- Secured the companion Chrome extension with token-based WebSocket/HTTP authentication and designed a hallucination-detection guard (content-novelty checks + sentiment filtering) to suppress false transcriptions in real time.

MVella Studios — Founder, Freelance Web Development 2025 – Present

- Design and ship production Next.js/TypeScript web applications for small-business clients, owning full-stack architecture, authentication, and secure payment integration end-to-end.
- Delivered e-commerce platforms (Holy Beliefs, OOT Tastings) with Stripe-driven checkout — no raw card data ever touches client infrastructure — and Supabase RLS policies enforcing per-tenant data isolation.
- Own client-facing infrastructure: custom domain email (Cloudflare + Resend SMTP) and recurring security/SEO audits.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance PC Builder & IT Support / AI Automation Consultant *Ongoing*

- Build custom PCs end-to-end (component selection, assembly, OS install, performance tuning) and provide ongoing remote/hands-on IT support for clients.
- Teach clients to build and run AI automations and agentic coding workflows for their own business use cases.